



MONGOLIANS

THE NOMADIC HORSE PEOPLE

MONGOLIA IS ONE OF THE HIGHEST countries in the world. The permanently snow-capped Altai mountains are to the west, and the Gobi Desert—an area of land that is in places almost completely uninhabitable—is to

Mongolian horses

It is impossible to imagine the Mongolians without the horse. It is the most beloved animal of the Mongolian people and the symbol of the Mongolian nation. Their small horses are stocky and spirited, with powerful necks, dense coats, and thick legs. They are very hardy animals and can run for hours without tiring. They stay outside on open pastures all year.

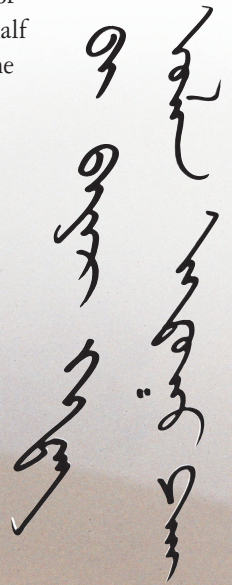


THE DEEL

Mongolia has seen some Westernization but traditional clothes, such as the *deel*, (a long textile gown with a sash) are still worn. The *deel* is heavy and very warm, protecting against cold temperatures and bitter winds.

MONGOLIAN SCRIPT

Neglected for more than half a century, the beautiful Mongolian script has resurfaced and is now recognized as an important aspect of national culture.



Both good riders and horses are held in high esteem, but the prestige largely goes to the horse.



THROAT SINGING

A sound that can be heard in Mongolia is throat singing. It is a unique sound using circular breathing so it sounds as if the the singer doesn't draw breath for 3-4 minutes.

